

Words That Do Two Jobs

Polysemous English words, ranked by how many *different domains* their senses fall into. These are the hinge words for Crosslink: put one in a crossing square and the two verbs touching it read on two different meanings, so the solver has to notice that the board is using the word twice.

How this is ranked

Not by raw sense count. A dictionary gives **break** sixty-odd senses, but they are all shades of one idea, and shades are no use here — two verbs cannot pick them apart. What a hinge needs is *distance*: senses that sit in unrelated corners of the world, so a verb attached to one cannot possibly be read as the other. **CRANE** has only three senses and is close to perfect, because a bird and a lifting machine share nothing but a silhouette.

So each word here is scored by the number of distinct domains its senses occupy — Animal, Music, Money, Body, Law, and so on. The domains are printed beside each word so you can disagree with the count at a glance.

How to use one

Give the square two verbs that cannot both be true of the same sense:

MINT —strikes a—> COIN

MINT —flavours—> TEA

One cell, two referents, and the solver only sees it when the second verb lands. A word with a clean two-way split (QUARRY, SENTENCE, CABINET) is often a better hinge than one with seven blurry senses — rank is a starting point, not a verdict. Watch for the ones marked with a note: those are the pairings worth building a board around.

Two free difficulty levers appear repeatedly below. **Stress shift** — PRESent and preSENT, OBject and obJECT — and **outright different pronunciation** — LEAD, BOW, ROW, SOW, BASS, MINUTE. A printed board cannot show either, so the page keeps the ambiguity the ear would resolve.

Provenance. This list and its domain tags are hand-built, not machine-extracted from WordNet, so treat the counts as an argument rather than a measurement. A WordNet pass would be exhaustive but noisier; it would also rank *break* and *set* at the top, which for this purpose is wrong.

The hinges 10 words

SEVEN OR MORE DOMAINS. RICH ENOUGH TO BUILD A WHOLE BOARD AROUND.

1 **STOCK** 8 domains · Food · Money · Animal · Military · Abstract · Trade · Plant · Law

FOOD the broth a soup is built on

MONEY shares in a company

ANIMAL livestock

MILITARY the wooden part of a gun

ABSTRACT descent, as in 'of good stock'

TRADE goods held in reserve

PLANT the flower, and a grafting rootstock

LAW the stocks, a punishment

Food and Money in one square. SOUP on one side, SHARE on the other.

2 BAR 7 domains · Place · Artifact · Music · Law · Nature · Action · Measure

PLACE where drink is served

ARTIFACT a rod of metal

MUSIC a measure of written music

LAW the profession, and the bar of a court

NATURE a sandbar at a river mouth

ACTION to bar the way

MEASURE a bar of pressure

*Music and Law is the elegant cross; Place and Nature is the funny one.***3 BRIDGE** 7 domains · Building · Game · Body · Music · Nautical · Science · Action

BUILDING the span over water

GAME the card game

BODY the bridge of the nose

MUSIC the piece under violin strings, and a song's middle section

NAUTICAL where a ship is commanded from

SCIENCE dentistry; a dental bridge

ACTION to bridge a gap

*Six referents, all concrete. One of the strongest hinges in English.***4 DRAUGHT** 7 domains · Nature · Drink · Military · Language · Nautical · Animal · Game

NATURE a current of air

DRINK beer served from the cask

MILITARY conscription (US draft)

LANGUAGE a preliminary version

NAUTICAL how deep a ship sits

ANIMAL a draught horse

GAME the game of draughts

*Spelling splits UK/US, which is itself a clue worth using.***5 HAND** 7 domains · Body · Artifact · Game · Person · Language · Action · Measure

BODY the end of the arm

ARTIFACT a clock hand

GAME the cards you hold

PERSON a worker; all hands on deck

LANGUAGE handwriting

ACTION applause; a big hand

MEASURE the height of a horse

*Body and Measure cross beautifully: HORSE and WRIST from one square.***6 HEAD** 7 domains · Body · Person · Food · Nautical · Nature · Measure · Action

BODY what sits on the neck

PERSON the person in charge

FOOD the foam on a beer

NAUTICAL the lavatory on a boat

NATURE the source of a river, and a headland

MEASURE cattle counted by the head

ACTION to head somewhere

Nature and Food is the surprise: SOURCE and BEER.

7 PITCH 7 domains · Sport · Music · Substance · Trade · Building · Action · Nautical

SPORT a throw, and the field played on

MUSIC how high a note sounds

SUBSTANCE black tar; pitch-black

TRADE a sales pitch

BUILDING the slope of a roof

ACTION to pitch a tent

NAUTICAL a ship pitching in swell

*Music and Substance are the cleanest pair: a note and a tar have nothing to say to each other.***8 RING** 7 domains · Shape · Artifact · Music · Sport · Group · Language · Plant

SHAPE a circle

ARTIFACT jewellery for a finger

MUSIC the sound a bell makes

SPORT where boxers fight

GROUP a criminal ring

LANGUAGE a telephone call

PLANT the growth rings of a tree

*Plant and Music: TREE on one axis, BELL on the other.***9 SHOT** 7 domains · Military · Art · Science · Abstract · Drink · Substance · Sport

MILITARY a fired round

ART a photograph or a camera shot

SCIENCE an injection

ABSTRACT an attempt; give it a shot

DRINK a small measure of spirits

SUBSTANCE lead pellets

SPORT the shot put

*Drink and Science: WHISKY and VACCINE, same four letters.***10 STRIKE** 7 domains · Action · Trade · Sport · Money · Nature · Time · Military

ACTION to hit

TRADE workers downing tools

SPORT in baseball, and in bowling

MONEY to strike a coin

NATURE an oil strike; a discovery

TIME a clock striking the hour

MILITARY an air strike

*Money and Trade sit oddly together: MINT strikes a COIN, UNION calls a STRIKE.***Six domains** 13 words

STILL COMFORTABLY MORE MEANINGS THAN ANY ONE PUZZLE NEEDS.

1 CELL 6 domains · Building · Science · Artifact · Group · Language · Body

BUILDING a room in a prison, and a monk's room

SCIENCE the unit of life

ARTIFACT a battery cell

GROUP a resistance or terrorist cell

LANGUAGE a cell in a spreadsheet or table

BODY a blood cell

Prison and biology. MONK and NUCLEUS from the same square.

2 CHARGE 6 domains · Money · Science · Military · Law · Person · Action

MONEY a fee

SCIENCE electrical charge

MILITARY a cavalry charge

LAW a criminal charge

PERSON someone in your care

ACTION to load a weapon or a battery

*Science and Law cross cleanly: ELECTRON and CRIME.***3 CRACK** 6 domains · Shape · Music · Language · Substance · Abstract · Attribute

SHAPE a fissure

MUSIC a sharp sound

LANGUAGE a joke; to crack wise

SUBSTANCE the drug

ABSTRACT an attempt; have a crack

ATTRIBUTE expert; a crack shot

4 CROWN 6 domains · Artifact · Body · Science · Money · Plant · Law

ARTIFACT what a monarch wears

BODY the top of the head

SCIENCE a cap on a tooth

MONEY the coin, and the currency

PLANT the top of a tree

LAW the Crown as the state

*Money and Plant: COIN and CANOPY.***5 FIGURE** 6 domains · Measure · Body · Person · Language · Action · Art

MEASURE a number

BODY the shape of a person

PERSON a notable person

LANGUAGE an illustration in a book

ACTION to reckon; I figure

ART a figure in a dance

6 KEY 6 domains · Artifact · Music · Tool · Language · Nature · Abstract

ARTIFACT what opens a lock

MUSIC the key a piece is written in

TOOL a piano or typewriter key

LANGUAGE a legend or answer key

NATURE a low island; the Florida Keys

ABSTRACT crucial, the key point

*Lock and music and island. Three sturdy, unrelated referents.***7 LEAD** 6 domains · Substance · Action · Artifact · Abstract · Sport · Tool

SUBSTANCE the soft grey metal

ACTION to guide

ARTIFACT a dog's lead

ABSTRACT a clue for an investigator

SPORT the front position

TOOL the graphite in a pencil

Two pronunciations, which the board cannot show. Free difficulty.

8 MOLE 6 domains · Animal · Body · Person · Measure · Building · Food

ANIMAL the burrowing creature

BODY a dark mark on skin

PERSON a spy inside an organisation

MEASURE the chemist's unit of quantity

BUILDING a breakwater or pier

FOOD the Mexican sauce

*Animal, spy, chemistry, sauce. Almost too good; use one pairing, not four.***9 RUN** 6 domains · Action · Textile · Sport · Trade · Nature · Language

ACTION to move fast on foot

TEXTILE a ladder in a stocking

SPORT a run in cricket or baseball

TRADE to run a business

NATURE a stream; a salmon run

LANGUAGE a print run

10 SCALE 6 domains · Animal · Tool · Music · Measure · Action · Substance

ANIMAL what covers a fish

TOOL the instrument that weighs

MUSIC the ladder of notes

MEASURE a map's ratio

ACTION to climb

SUBSTANCE limescale in a kettle

*Animal and Music: CARP and OCTAVE.***11 SHELL** 6 domains · Animal · Military · Building · Food · Science · Language

ANIMAL what a mollusc lives in

MILITARY artillery ammunition

BUILDING the frame of a building

FOOD a pastry case

SCIENCE an electron shell

LANGUAGE a command shell

*Animal and Military: SNAIL and CANNON.***12 TRUNK** 6 domains · Plant · Animal · Artifact · Vehicle · Body · Place

PLANT the stem of a tree

ANIMAL an elephant's nose

ARTIFACT a travelling chest

VEHICLE the boot of a car

BODY the torso

PLACE a trunk road or trunk line

*Plant and Animal in one word is rare and very usable.***13 WING** 6 domains · Animal · Vehicle · Building · Abstract · Place · Sport

ANIMAL what a bird flies with

VEHICLE an aircraft wing

BUILDING a wing of a house

ABSTRACT a political wing

PLACE the wings of a theatre

SPORT a winger's position

Animal and Building: SPARROW and HOSPITAL.

Five domains 30 words

THE WORKING MIDDLE OF THE LIST.

1 **BANK** 5 domains · Nature · Money · Artifact · Action · Abstract

NATURE the edge of a river

MONEY where money is kept

ARTIFACT a bank of oars, lights, switches

ACTION to bank an aircraft

ABSTRACT to bank on something

The classic. Nature and Money: RIVER and VAULT.

2 **BATTERY** 5 domains · Artifact · Law · Military · Sport · Abstract

ARTIFACT what stores charge

LAW assault and battery

MILITARY a group of guns

SPORT the pitcher and catcher together

ABSTRACT a battery of tests

Artifact and Law: TORCH and ASSAULT.

3 **BAY** 5 domains · Nature · Plant · Animal · Action · Building

NATURE an inlet of the sea

PLANT the laurel; bay leaves

ANIMAL a reddish-brown horse

ACTION to howl; hounds baying

BUILDING a loading bay or bay window

Nature and Plant and Animal. A rare three-way among concrete things.

4 **BEAR** 5 domains · Animal · Action · Abstract · Money · Science

ANIMAL the large mammal

ACTION to carry

ABSTRACT to endure

MONEY a falling market

SCIENCE to give birth to

Animal and Money: FOREST and MARKET, with BULL waiting in the next square.

5 **BILL** 5 domains · Money · Animal · Law · Language · Textile

MONEY an invoice, and a banknote

ANIMAL a bird's beak

LAW a proposed act of parliament

LANGUAGE a poster; to bill a show

TEXTILE the brim of a cap

Animal and Law: DUCK and PARLIAMENT.

6 **BOARD** 5 domains · Artifact · Group · Food · Action · Game

ARTIFACT a plank of wood

GROUP the directors of a company

FOOD meals; room and board

ACTION to board a ship

GAME the surface a game is played on

7 BOLT 5 domains · Artifact · Nature · Action · Textile · Military

ARTIFACT a threaded fastener

NATURE a bolt of lightning

ACTION to bolt; to run away

TEXTILE a roll of cloth

MILITARY a crossbow bolt

*Artifact and Nature: NUT and LIGHTNING.***8 BOW** 5 domains · Military · Music · Textile · Action · Nautical

MILITARY the weapon that fires arrows

MUSIC what draws across violin strings

TEXTILE a tied ribbon

ACTION to bend at the waist

NAUTICAL the front of a ship

*Also two pronunciations. Pair it with STERN and the ship sense locks.***9 BULL** 5 domains · Animal · Money · Religion · Abstract · Sport

ANIMAL the male of cattle

MONEY a rising market

RELIGION a papal bull

ABSTRACT nonsense

SPORT the bullseye

*Pair it with BEAR on the same board and the market does the crossing.***10 CAPITAL** 5 domains · Place · Money · Language · Building · Law

PLACE the chief city

MONEY funds and assets

LANGUAGE an upper-case letter

BUILDING the carved top of a column

LAW punishable by death

*Building and Language is the best cross: COLUMN and LETTER.***11 CASE** 5 domains · Artifact · Law · Language · Science · Abstract

ARTIFACT a container

LAW a legal matter

LANGUAGE the grammatical case; nominative, dative

SCIENCE a patient

ABSTRACT an instance

*Law and Language: TRIAL and DATIVE.***12 CHECK** 5 domains · Action · Game · Money · Textile · Language

ACTION to verify

GAME in chess

MONEY the bill, and the cheque

TEXTILE the pattern

LANGUAGE the tick mark

Game and Textile: CHESS and TARTAN.

13 CHIP 5 domains · Food · Science · Game · Object · Sport

FOOD a fried potato

SCIENCE a silicon chip

GAME a gambling token

OBJECT a fragment broken off

SPORT a chip shot

*Food and Science: POTATO and SILICON.***14 CLUB** 5 domains · Artifact · Group · Place · Sport · Game

ARTIFACT a heavy stick

GROUP a society

PLACE a nightclub

SPORT a golf club

GAME the card suit

15 COMPOUND 5 domains · Science · Place · Action · Language · Money

SCIENCE a chemical combination

PLACE a walled enclosure

ACTION to make worse; to compound a problem

LANGUAGE a compound word

MONEY compound interest

*Science and Place: MOLECULE and FENCE.***16 COURT** 5 domains · Law · Group · Sport · Place · Action

LAW where a case is heard

GROUP a monarch's household

SPORT where tennis is played

PLACE a courtyard

ACTION to court someone

*Law and Sport: JUDGE and TENNIS.***17 EYE** 5 domains · Body · Tool · Nature · Plant · Textile

BODY the organ of sight

TOOL the eye of a needle

NATURE the calm centre of a storm

PLANT the eye of a potato

TEXTILE a hook and eye

*Body and Tool: SIGHT and NEEDLE.***18 FILE** 5 domains · Artifact · Tool · Group · Game · Law

ARTIFACT a folder of papers

TOOL the metal rasp

GROUP a line of people; single file

GAME a column on a chessboard

LAW to file a claim

*Artifact and Tool: PAPER and RASP.***19 HORN** 5 domains · Body · Music · Artifact · Nature · Drink

BODY what grows on a bull's head

MUSIC the brass instrument

ARTIFACT a car horn

NATURE a cape; Cape Horn

DRINK a drinking horn

20 HOST 5 domains · Person · Measure · Science · Religion · Military

PERSON one who receives guests

MEASURE a great multitude

SCIENCE the organism a parasite lives on

RELIGION the communion wafer

MILITARY an army; the heavenly host

*Person and Science: GUEST and PARASITE.***21 JAM** 5 domains · Food · Vehicle · Action · Music · Abstract

FOOD fruit preserve

VEHICLE a traffic jam

ACTION to wedge tight

MUSIC a jam session

ABSTRACT a difficulty; in a jam

*Food and Music: TOAST and SESSION.***22 MEDIUM** 5 domains · Measure · Person · Language · Art · Science

MEASURE the middle size

PERSON one who speaks to the dead

LANGUAGE a means of communication

ART the material an artist works in

SCIENCE a growth medium

23 PAN 5 domains · Artifact · Language · Art · Action · Nature

ARTIFACT the cooking vessel

LANGUAGE to pan a film; to criticise

ART a camera pan

ACTION to pan for gold

NATURE a salt pan

24 PORT 5 domains · Place · Drink · Nautical · Language · Action

PLACE a harbour

DRINK the fortified wine

NAUTICAL the left side of a ship

LANGUAGE a socket on a machine

ACTION to port software across

*Place and Drink: HARBOUR and WINE, which are also historically the same thing.***25 SOUND** 5 domains · Music · Attribute · Nature · Nautical · Action

MUSIC what the ear hears

ATTRIBUTE solid, healthy, sound reasoning

NATURE a strait of water; Puget Sound

NAUTICAL to sound the depth

ACTION to sound out

*Music and Nature: NOISE and STRAIT.***26 SPRING** 5 domains · Time · Nature · Artifact · Action · Abstract

TIME the season

NATURE water rising from the ground

ARTIFACT a coil of metal

ACTION to leap

ABSTRACT the origin of a thing

Time and Artifact: MARCH and WATCH.

27 TABLE 5 domains · Artifact · Language · Nature · Law · Food

ARTIFACT the furniture

LANGUAGE a grid of data

NATURE a tableland or plateau; the water table

LAW to table a motion

FOOD the table one eats at

28 TIP 5 domains · Shape · Money · Language · Action · Place

SHAPE the pointed end

MONEY a gratuity

LANGUAGE a piece of advice

ACTION to tilt over

PLACE a rubbish tip

29 TONGUE 5 domains · Body · Language · Textile · Nature · Artifact

BODY the organ in the mouth

LANGUAGE a language; the mother tongue

TEXTILE the flap under a shoelace

NATURE a spit of land

ARTIFACT the clapper of a bell

*Body and Language, which is the same metaphor made literal. Very Crosslink.***30 TRAIN** 5 domains · Vehicle · Action · Textile · Abstract · Group

VEHICLE the thing on rails

ACTION to teach by repetition

TEXTILE the trailing part of a dress

ABSTRACT a train of thought

GROUP a retinue

Four domains 44 words

RELIABLE, AND LESS LIKELY TO FEEL LIKE A TRICK.

1 BUCK 4 domains · Animal · Money · Action · Abstract

ANIMAL a male deer

MONEY a dollar

ACTION to throw a rider

ABSTRACT responsibility; the buck stops here

2 BUFF 4 domains · Attribute · Person · Action · Textile

ATTRIBUTE the pale yellow colour

PERSON an enthusiast

ACTION to polish

TEXTILE buff leather

3 CHAIR 4 domains · Artifact · Person · Abstract · Law

ARTIFACT the furniture

PERSON who runs a meeting

ABSTRACT a professorship

LAW the electric chair

4 COMPANY 4 domains · Trade · Group · Military · Art

TRADE a business

GROUP guests; we have company

MILITARY a unit of soldiers

ART a theatre or dance company

5 CONSOLE 4 domains · Action · Artifact · Game · Building

ACTION to comfort

ARTIFACT a control panel

GAME a games console

BUILDING a bracket or console table

6 CRAB 4 domains · Animal · Plant · Action · Person

ANIMAL the shellfish

PLANT the crab apple

ACTION to move sideways

PERSON a bad-tempered one

7 DIAMOND 4 domains · Substance · Game · Sport · Shape

SUBSTANCE the gem

GAME the card suit

SPORT the baseball infield

SHAPE the rhombus

8 DUCK 4 domains · Animal · Action · Sport · Textile

ANIMAL the water bird

ACTION to dodge downward

SPORT a score of nought in cricket

TEXTILE a heavy cotton cloth

9 FAIR 4 domains · Abstract · Attribute · Trade · Nature

ABSTRACT just

ATTRIBUTE light in colour

TRADE a market or funfair

NATURE fine weather

10 FAN 4 domains · Artifact · Person · Shape · Action

ARTIFACT what moves air

PERSON an enthusiast

SHAPE a fan shape

ACTION to fan out

*Artifact and Person, and they are the same word only by coincidence (fanatic).***11 FINE** 4 domains · Attribute · Law · Measure · Nature

ATTRIBUTE excellent

LAW a money penalty

MEASURE thin or delicate

NATURE clear weather

Attribute and Law: EXCELLENT and PENALTY, which are opposites in feeling.

12 FOOT 4 domains · Body · Measure · Language · Place

BODY the end of the leg

MEASURE twelve inches

LANGUAGE a metrical foot in verse

PLACE the foot of a hill or a bed

*Body and Measure and Language, all three respectable.***13 GUM** 4 domains · Food · Body · Plant · Substance

FOOD chewing gum

BODY the flesh around teeth

PLANT tree resin; a gum tree

SUBSTANCE adhesive

14 HEART 4 domains · Body · Game · Abstract · Place

BODY the organ

GAME the card suit

ABSTRACT courage; take heart

PLACE the centre; the heart of the city

15 HEEL 4 domains · Body · Textile · Food · Person

BODY the back of the foot

TEXTILE the back of a shoe

FOOD the end slice of a loaf

PERSON a cad

16 KID 4 domains · Person · Animal · Textile · Action

PERSON a child

ANIMAL a young goat

TEXTILE soft leather; kid gloves

ACTION to joke; you're kidding

*Person and Animal and Textile, and all three are the same animal by history.***17 LAP** 4 domains · Body · Sport · Action · Shape

BODY the thighs when seated

SPORT one circuit of a track

ACTION to drink as a cat does

SHAPE an overlap

18 LEG 4 domains · Body · Artifact · Sport · Game

BODY what you stand on

ARTIFACT a table leg

SPORT one stage of a journey or a tie

GAME the leg side in cricket

19 LIGHT 4 domains · Nature · Measure · Action · Attribute

NATURE what the sun gives

MEASURE not heavy

ACTION to set alight

ATTRIBUTE pale in colour

Nature and Measure: SUN and FEATHER.

20 LOG 4 domains · Plant · Language · Measure · Nautical

PLANT a felled length of tree

LANGUAGE a written record

MEASURE a logarithm

NAUTICAL a ship's log and log-line

*Plant and Language: TIMBER and DIARY, and they are the same word by history.***21 MATCH** 4 domains · Artifact · Sport · Abstract · Person

ARTIFACT the small fire-stick

SPORT a contest

ABSTRACT an equal or a pair

PERSON a marriage match

*Artifact and Sport: FLAME and FOOTBALL.***22 MEAN** 4 domains · Measure · Language · Attribute · Action

MEASURE the average

LANGUAGE to signify

ATTRIBUTE unkind

ACTION to intend

23 MINT 4 domains · Plant · Money · Attribute · Food

PLANT the herb

MONEY where coins are struck

ATTRIBUTE perfect; mint condition

FOOD a boiled sweet

*Plant and Money: TEA and COIN. The example that started this.***24 NECK** 4 domains · Body · Artifact · Music · Nature

BODY between head and shoulders

ARTIFACT the neck of a bottle

MUSIC the neck of a guitar

NATURE an isthmus

25 NOTE 4 domains · Music · Language · Money · Action

MUSIC a single sound

LANGUAGE a written message

MONEY a banknote

ACTION to notice

*Music and Money: OCTAVE and TENNER.***26 ORGAN** 4 domains · Body · Music · Language · Group

BODY the heart, the liver

MUSIC the instrument with pipes

LANGUAGE a newspaper; the party organ

GROUP a part of an institution

*Body and Music: LIVER and PIPE.***27 PLANT** 4 domains · Plant · Building · Action · Person

PLANT a growing thing

BUILDING a factory

ACTION to put a seed in the ground

PERSON an informer placed inside

28 PLOT 4 domains · Language · Place · Abstract · Measure

LANGUAGE the story of a novel

PLACE a parcel of land

ABSTRACT a conspiracy

MEASURE to plot on a graph

*Language and Place: NOVEL and GRAVEYARD.***29 POST** 4 domains · Artifact · Language · Person · Military

ARTIFACT an upright timber

LANGUAGE the mail, and to publish

PERSON a job or position

MILITARY a station one is posted to

30 POT 4 domains · Artifact · Substance · Game · Sport

ARTIFACT the cooking vessel

SUBSTANCE cannabis

GAME the stake in a card game

SPORT to pot a ball

31 POUND 4 domains · Measure · Money · Action · Place

MEASURE a unit of weight

MONEY the currency

ACTION to beat repeatedly

PLACE where stray dogs are kept

*Money and Place: STERLING and DOG.***32 PRESENT** 4 domains · Object · Time · Action · Attribute

OBJECT a gift

TIME now

ACTION to introduce or hand over

ATTRIBUTE in attendance

*Time and Object, and the stress moves. PRESent and preSENT.***33 PRESS** 4 domains · Action · Language · Artifact · Sport

ACTION to push

LANGUAGE newspapers collectively

ARTIFACT the printing machine

SPORT a weightlifting press

34 ROCK 4 domains · Substance · Music · Action · Object

SUBSTANCE stone

MUSIC the music

ACTION to sway

OBJECT a diamond

35 SEAL 4 domains · Animal · Artifact · Action · Tool

ANIMAL the sea mammal

ARTIFACT a stamp pressed into wax

ACTION to close something tight

TOOL a gasket or washer

Animal and Artifact: WALRUS and WAX.

36 SECOND 4 domains · Time · Measure · Law · Person

TIME one sixtieth of a minute

MEASURE the one after first

LAW to second a motion

PERSON the assistant at a duel

*Time and Measure, and the two are historically the same idea.***37 SOLE** 4 domains · Body · Textile · Animal · Attribute

BODY the underside of the foot

TEXTILE the underside of a shoe

ANIMAL the flatfish

ATTRIBUTE only; the sole survivor

*Animal and Body: PLAICE and FOOT.***38 SPELL** 4 domains · Religion · Language · Time · Trade

RELIGION words of magic

LANGUAGE to give the letters in order

TIME a period; a cold spell

TRADE a turn at work

*Religion and Language: WITCH and ALPHABET.***39 SPINE** 4 domains · Body · Artifact · Plant · Abstract

BODY the backbone

ARTIFACT the edge of a book

PLANT a thorn

ABSTRACT courage

*Body and Artifact: VERTEBRA and BOOK.***40 SPIRIT** 4 domains · Religion · Drink · Abstract · Science

RELIGION the soul, and a ghost

DRINK distilled alcohol

ABSTRACT morale; team spirit

SCIENCE a volatile solvent

*Religion and Drink: GHOST and GIN.***41 SUBJECT** 4 domains · Abstract · Person · Language · Science

ABSTRACT the topic at hand

PERSON a citizen of a monarch

LANGUAGE the subject of a sentence

SCIENCE a person in an experiment

*Language and Person: VERB and MONARCH.***42 SUIT** 4 domains · Textile · Game · Law · Action

TEXTILE the set of clothes

GAME the card suit

LAW a lawsuit

ACTION to be fitting; it suits you

43 TURKEY 4 domains · Place · Animal · Abstract · Sport

PLACE the country

ANIMAL the bird

ABSTRACT a flop; a bad film

SPORT three strikes in bowling

The bird is named for the country by a mistake, which is a clue in itself.

44 WAVE 4 domains · Nature · Action · Science · Body

NATURE water rising and falling

ACTION a greeting with the hand

SCIENCE in physics; light and sound

BODY a wave in the hair

Three domains 35 words

USUALLY ONE STRONG PAIRING AND A SPARE.

1 ARMS 3 domains · Body · Military · Abstract

BODY the two limbs

MILITARY weapons

ABSTRACT a coat of arms

2 ARTICLE 3 domains · Language · Object · Law

LANGUAGE a piece of writing, and a, an, the

OBJECT a thing; an article of clothing

LAW a clause of a treaty

3 BAT 3 domains · Animal · Sport · Action

ANIMAL the flying mammal

SPORT what a batsman holds

ACTION to bat an eyelid

*Animal and Sport: CAVE and CRICKET.***4 CALF** 3 domains · Animal · Body · Nature

ANIMAL a young cow

BODY the muscle below the knee

NATURE an iceberg calving from a glacier

*Animal and Body: COW and SHIN.***5 CHEST** 3 domains · Body · Artifact · Building

BODY the ribcage

ARTIFACT a strong box

BUILDING a chest of drawers

6 CONTRACT 3 domains · Law · Action · Science

LAW a binding agreement

ACTION to shrink

SCIENCE to catch a disease

*Law and Action: SIGNATURE and MUSCLE.***7 CRANE** 3 domains · Animal · Artifact · Action

ANIMAL the long-legged bird

ARTIFACT the lifting machine

ACTION to crane one's neck

*The purest hinge in English: the machine is named for the bird. Two clean domains, no mush.***8 CULTURE** 3 domains · Group · Science · Art

GROUP the customs of a people

SCIENCE bacteria grown in a dish

ART the arts collectively

Group and Science: NATION and PETRI DISH.

9 CURRENT 3 domains · Nature · Science · Time

NATURE the flow of water

SCIENCE the flow of electricity

TIME present-day

10 DESERT 3 domains · Nature · Action · Abstract

NATURE arid land

ACTION to abandon

ABSTRACT what one deserves; just deserts

*Stress moves between the first two. DESert and deSERT.***11 EAR** 3 domains · Body · Plant · Music

BODY the organ of hearing

PLANT an ear of corn

MUSIC a good ear; an ear for music

*Body and Plant: HEARING and MAIZE.***12 FAST** 3 domains · Measure · Religion · Attribute

MEASURE quick

RELIGION to go without food

ATTRIBUTE firmly fixed; hold fast

*Quick and abstaining and immovable. Two of the three are near-opposites.***13 FLUKE** 3 domains · Abstract · Animal · Nautical

ABSTRACT a stroke of luck

ANIMAL the tail of a whale, and a parasitic worm

NAUTICAL the barb of an anchor

14 GRAVE 3 domains · Place · Attribute · Language

PLACE a burial place

ATTRIBUTE serious

LANGUAGE the accent mark; grave and acute

15 IRIS 3 domains · Body · Plant · Artifact

BODY the coloured ring of the eye

PLANT the flower

ARTIFACT a camera aperture

*Body and Plant: PUPIL and PETAL.***16 JERSEY** 3 domains · Place · Textile · Animal

PLACE the Channel island

TEXTILE a knitted shirt

ANIMAL the breed of cow

17 LIE 3 domains · Language · Action · Sport

LANGUAGE an untruth

ACTION to be horizontal

SPORT where the golf ball sits

18 MASS 3 domains · Science · Religion · Measure

SCIENCE how much matter a thing has

RELIGION the church service

MEASURE a large quantity

Science and Religion: GRAVITY and CHURCH.

19 MINUTE 3 domains · Time · Measure · Language

TIME sixty seconds

MEASURE tiny; a minute quantity

LANGUAGE the written record of a meeting

*Pronounced two ways, spelled one. MINute and myNEWT.***20 MOMENT** 3 domains · Time · Science · Abstract

TIME a short while

SCIENCE turning force about a point

ABSTRACT importance; of great moment

21 MOUTH 3 domains · Body · Nature · Place

BODY where food goes in

NATURE where a river meets the sea

PLACE the entrance to a cave

*Body and Nature: TEETH and DELTA.***22 NAIL** 3 domains · Body · Artifact · Action

BODY what grows on a finger

ARTIFACT the metal fastener

ACTION to succeed; nailed it

*Body and Artifact: THUMB and HAMMER.***23 OBJECT** 3 domains · Object · Action · Language

OBJECT a thing

ACTION to protest

LANGUAGE the object of a verb

*Stress moves. OBject and obJECT.***24 PALM** 3 domains · Body · Plant · Action

BODY the inside of the hand

PLANT the tree

ACTION to conceal in the hand

*Body and Plant: HAND and DATE.***25 ROW** 3 domains · Shape · Group · Action

SHAPE a line of things

GROUP a quarrel

ACTION to propel a boat with oars

*Two pronunciations again. ROE is a homophone of one of them; keep them apart on a board.***26 SAGE** 3 domains · Plant · Person · Attribute

PLANT the herb

PERSON a wise elder

ATTRIBUTE the grey-green colour

*Plant and Person: THYME and PHILOSOPHER.***27 SEASON** 3 domains · Time · Food · Trade

TIME one of the four

FOOD to add salt and spice

TRADE to age timber until it is ready

Time and Food: AUTUMN and PEPPER.

28 SINK 3 domains · Artifact · Action · Science

ARTIFACT the basin

ACTION to go under

SCIENCE a heat sink

29 STAMP 3 domains · Language · Action · Tool

LANGUAGE what franks a letter

ACTION to bring the foot down

TOOL the die that makes a mark

30 STAPLE 3 domains · Artifact · Food · Trade

ARTIFACT the wire fastener

FOOD a basic foodstuff

TRADE a principal product

*Artifact and Food: PAPER and RICE.***31 TEMPLE** 3 domains · Building · Body · Artifact

BUILDING a place of worship

BODY the side of the forehead

ARTIFACT the arm of a pair of spectacles

*Building and Body: ALTAR and SKULL.***32 TOOTH** 3 domains · Body · Artifact · Tool

BODY what bites

ARTIFACT a tooth on a gear or comb

TOOL a saw tooth

33 VOLUME 3 domains · Language · Music · Measure

LANGUAGE a book, one of several

MUSIC loudness

MEASURE how much space a thing fills

*Language and Measure: LIBRARY and LITRE.***34 WELL** 3 domains · Nature · Attribute · Building

NATURE a shaft sunk for water

ATTRIBUTE in good health

BUILDING a stairwell

*Nature and Attribute: WATER and HEALTH.***35 YARD** 3 domains · Measure · Place · Nautical

MEASURE three feet

PLACE an enclosed space

NAUTICAL the spar a sail hangs from

Clean two-way splits 17 words

FEWEST SENSES, LEAST AMBIGUITY, AND OFTEN THE MOST ELEGANT CROSSINGS ON A BOARD.

1 BASS 2 domains · Music · Animal

MUSIC the low register

ANIMAL the fish

Two pronunciations. GUITAR and TROUT.

2 CABINET 2 domains · Artifact · Group

ARTIFACT a cupboard

GROUP the ministers of a government

*MINISTER and DRAWER. Clean, and historically the same small room.***3 CHINA** 2 domains · Place · Substance

PLACE the country

SUBSTANCE porcelain

*A place that became a material. See also JERSEY, DENIM, CASHMERE, TURKEY.***4 NOVEL** 2 domains · Language · Attribute

LANGUAGE a long work of fiction

ATTRIBUTE new and unusual

5 PATIENT 2 domains · Science · Attribute

SCIENCE one under a doctor's care

ATTRIBUTE able to wait without complaint

6 PUPIL 2 domains · Person · Body

PERSON a student

BODY the opening in the eye

*TEACHER and IRIS. Famous, and the two are the same word by origin.***7 QUARRY** 2 domains · Place · Animal

PLACE where stone is cut

ANIMAL the hunted creature

*Two domains, zero overlap, unrelated by origin. A model two-way hinge.***8 REFRAIN** 2 domains · Action · Music

ACTION to hold back from doing

MUSIC the repeated chorus

9 SENTENCE 2 domains · Language · Law

LANGUAGE a complete thought in words

LAW the punishment a judge gives

*Only two, but perfectly clean: GRAMMAR and PRISON. Better than a word with seven mushy senses.***10 SEWER** 2 domains · Building · Person

BUILDING the drain under a city

PERSON one who sews

11 SOLUTION 2 domains · Abstract · Science

ABSTRACT the answer to a problem

SCIENCE a liquid with something dissolved in it

*PUZZLE and SALT, which is a Crosslink joke waiting to happen.***12 SOW** 2 domains · Animal · Action

ANIMAL a female pig

ACTION to scatter seed

*Two pronunciations, and the pair PIG / SEED is very clean.***13 SPADE** 2 domains · Tool · Game

TOOL the digging implement

GAME the card suit

14 STABLE 2 domains · Building · Attribute
BUILDING where horses are kept
ATTRIBUTE steady, not liable to fall

15 STERN 2 domains · Nautical · Attribute
NAUTICAL the back of a ship
ATTRIBUTE severe
Put BOW in another square and the pair does the work.

16 TEAR 2 domains · Body · Action
BODY what falls from the eye
ACTION to rip

17 WIND 2 domains · Nature · Action
NATURE moving air
ACTION to turn a handle or a clock

Index by domain

WHICH WORDS CAN REACH INTO EACH CORNER OF THE WORLD

ABSTRACT	ARMS, BANK, BATTERY, BEAR, BUCK, BULL, CASE, CHAIR, CRACK, DESERT, FAIR, FLUKE, HEART, JAM, KEY, LEAD, MATCH, MOMENT, PLOT, SHOT, SOLUTION, SPINE, SPIRIT, SPRING, STOCK, SUBJECT, TRAIN, TURKEY, WING
ACTION	BANK, BAR, BAT, BAY, BEAR, BOARD, BOLT, BOW, BRIDGE, BUCK, BUFF, CHARGE, CHECK, COMPOUND, CONSOLE, CONTRACT, COURT, CRAB, CRANE, DESERT, DUCK, FAN, FIGURE, HAND, HEAD, JAM, KID, LAP, LEAD, LIE, LIGHT, MEAN, NAIL, NOTE, OBJECT, PALM, PAN, PITCH, PLANT, PORT, POUND, PRESENT, PRESS, REFRAIN, ROCK, ROW, RUN, SCALE, SEAL, SINK, SOUND, SOW, SPRING, STAMP, STRIKE, SUIT, TEAR, TIP, TRAIN, WAVE, WIND
ANIMAL	BASS, BAT, BAY, BEAR, BILL, BUCK, BULL, CALF, CRAB, CRANE, DRAUGHT, DUCK, FLUKE, JERSEY, KID, MOLE, QUARRY, SCALE, SEAL, SHELL, SOLE, SOW, STOCK, TRUNK, TURKEY, WING
ART	COMPANY, CULTURE, FIGURE, MEDIUM, PAN, SHOT
ARTIFACT	BANK, BAR, BATTERY, BOARD, BOLT, CABINET, CASE, CELL, CHAIR, CHEST, CLUB, CONSOLE, CRANE, CROWN, FAN, FILE, HAND, HORN, IRIS, KEY, LEAD, LEG, MATCH, NAIL, NECK, PAN, POST, POT, PRESS, RING, SEAL, SINK, SPINE, SPRING, STAPLE, TABLE, TEMPLE, TONGUE, TOOTH, TRUNK
ATTRIBUTE	BUFF, CRACK, FAIR, FAST, FINE, GRAVE, LIGHT, MEAN, MINT, NOVEL, PATIENT, PRESENT, SAGE, SOLE, SOUND, STABLE, STERN, WELL
BODY	ARMS, BRIDGE, CALF, CELL, CHEST, CROWN, EAR, EYE, FIGURE, FOOT, GUM, HAND, HEAD, HEART, HEEL, HORN, IRIS, LAP, LEG, MOLE, MOUTH, NAIL, NECK, ORGAN, PALM, PUPIL, SOLE, SPINE, TEAR, TEMPLE, TONGUE, TOOTH, TRUNK, WAVE
BUILDING	BAY, BRIDGE, CAPITAL, CELL, CHEST, CONSOLE, MOLE, PITCH, PLANT, SEWER, SHELL, STABLE, TEMPLE, WELL, WING
DRINK	DRAUGHT, HORN, PORT, SHOT, SPIRIT
FOOD	BOARD, CHIP, GUM, HEAD, HEEL, JAM, MINT, MOLE, SEASON, SHELL, STAPLE, STOCK, TABLE
GAME	BOARD, BRIDGE, CHECK, CHIP, CLUB, CONSOLE, DIAMOND, DRAUGHT, FILE, HAND, HEART, LEG, POT, SPADE, SUIT
GROUP	BOARD, CABINET, CELL, CLUB, COMPANY, COURT, CULTURE, FILE, ORGAN, RING, ROW, TRAIN

LANGUAGE	ARTICLE, BILL, CAPITAL, CASE, CELL, CHECK, COMPOUND, CRACK, DRAUGHT, FIGURE, FOOT, GRAVE, HAND, KEY, LIE, LOG, MEAN, MEDIUM, MINUTE, NOTE, NOVEL, OBJECT, ORGAN, PAN, PLOT, PORT, POST, PRESS, RING, RUN, SENTENCE, SHELL, SPELL, STAMP, SUBJECT, TABLE, TIP, TONGUE, VOLUME
LAW	ARTICLE, BAR, BATTERY, BILL, CAPITAL, CASE, CHAIR, CHARGE, CONTRACT, COURT, CROWN, FILE, FINE, SECOND, SENTENCE, STOCK, SUIT, TABLE
MEASURE	BAR, FAST, FIGURE, FINE, FOOT, HAND, HEAD, HOST, LIGHT, LOG, MASS, MEAN, MEDIUM, MINUTE, MOLE, PLOT, POUND, SCALE, SECOND, VOLUME, YARD
MILITARY	ARMS, BATTERY, BOLT, BOW, CHARGE, COMPANY, DRAUGHT, HOST, POST, SHELL, SHOT, STOCK, STRIKE
MONEY	BANK, BEAR, BILL, BUCK, BULL, CAPITAL, CHARGE, CHECK, COMPOUND, CROWN, MINT, NOTE, POUND, STOCK, STRIKE, TIP
MUSIC	BAR, BASS, BOW, BRIDGE, CRACK, EAR, HORN, JAM, KEY, NECK, NOTE, ORGAN, PITCH, REFRAIN, RING, ROCK, SCALE, SOUND, VOLUME
NATURE	BANK, BAR, BAY, BOLT, CALF, CURRENT, DESERT, DRAUGHT, EYE, FAIR, FINE, HEAD, HORN, KEY, LIGHT, MOUTH, NECK, PAN, RUN, SOUND, SPRING, STRIKE, TABLE, TONGUE, WAVE, WELL, WIND
NAUTICAL	BOW, BRIDGE, DRAUGHT, FLUKE, HEAD, LOG, PITCH, PORT, SOUND, STERN, YARD
OBJECT	ARTICLE, CHIP, OBJECT, PRESENT, ROCK
PERSON	BUFF, CHAIR, CHARGE, CRAB, FAN, FIGURE, HAND, HEAD, HEEL, HOST, KID, MATCH, MEDIUM, MOLE, PLANT, POST, PUPIL, SAGE, SECOND, SEWER, SUBJECT
PLACE	BAR, CAPITAL, CHINA, CLUB, COMPOUND, COURT, FOOT, GRAVE, HEART, JERSEY, MOUTH, PLOT, PORT, POUND, QUARRY, TIP, TRUNK, TURKEY, WING, YARD
PLANT	BAY, CRAB, CROWN, EAR, EYE, GUM, IRIS, LOG, MINT, PALM, PLANT, RING, SAGE, SPINE, STOCK, TRUNK
RELIGION	BULL, FAST, HOST, MASS, SPELL, SPIRIT
SCIENCE	BEAR, BRIDGE, CASE, CELL, CHARGE, CHIP, COMPOUND, CONTRACT, CROWN, CULTURE, CURRENT, HOST, MASS, MEDIUM, MOMENT, PATIENT, SHELL, SHOT, SINK, SOLUTION, SPIRIT, SUBJECT, WAVE
SHAPE	CRACK, DIAMOND, FAN, LAP, RING, ROW, TIP
SPORT	BAT, BATTERY, BULL, CHIP, CLUB, COURT, DIAMOND, DUCK, LAP, LEAD, LEG, LIE, MATCH, PITCH, POT, PRESS, RING, RUN, SHOT, STRIKE, TURKEY, WING
SUBSTANCE	CHINA, CRACK, DIAMOND, GUM, LEAD, PITCH, POT, ROCK, SCALE, SHOT
TEXTILE	BILL, BOLT, BOW, BUFF, CHECK, DUCK, EYE, HEEL, JERSEY, KID, RUN, SOLE, SUIT, TONGUE, TRAIN
TIME	CURRENT, MINUTE, MOMENT, PRESENT, SEASON, SECOND, SPELL, SPRING, STRIKE
TOOL	EYE, FILE, KEY, LEAD, SCALE, SEAL, SPADE, STAMP, TOOTH
TRADE	COMPANY, FAIR, PITCH, RUN, SEASON, SPELL, STAPLE, STOCK, STRIKE
VEHICLE	JAM, TRAIN, TRUNK, WING